CREATING THE VALUE PROPOSITION

ShopBot — Business Model Canvas and Value Proposition Canvas

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Abstract: This report continues the development of ShopBot, a Telegram commerce platform for businesses in Kazakhstan that was introduced in Assignment 1. The report first explains why ShopBot follows a business-to-business (B2B) model and gives an overview of its full business model using the Business Model Canvas. It then builds the value proposition for ShopBot's main customer segment, small and medium enterprises (SMEs), with the help of the Value Proposition Canvas. Finally, it describes ShopBot's customer segments and the relationships the company will build with each of them. The analysis shows that ShopBot solves real problems of Kazakhstani SMEs, especially the high cost of going online and the lack of IT staff.

Keywords: business model, value proposition, Business Model Canvas, Value Proposition Canvas, B2B SaaS, multi-sided platform, Telegram commerce.

1. Introduction

A business model describes how a company creates value for its customers and how it earns money from this value. It answers four questions: what the company sells, how it markets its product, what expenses it has, and how it makes a profit. The most important part of any business model is the value proposition, which explains why customers should choose this company instead of its competitors (Osterwalder & Pigneur, 2010).

ShopBot is a Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) platform that lets small and medium businesses open their own shop inside the Telegram messenger without writing any code. The purpose of this report is to choose the right business model category for ShopBot, to describe its business model, and to build a clear value proposition for its customers.

2. Step 1. Choosing the Business Model Category

ShopBot follows a **business-to-business (B2B)** model, because its paying customers are companies, not individual shoppers. Small and medium enterprises such as retail shops, cafes, beauty salons and pharmacies pay ShopBot a monthly subscription to get a ready-made Telegram shopping bot with a catalog, cart, payment integration and order dashboard. The subscription is tiered, so each business pays only for the features it needs. Shoppers use the bot to browse and order, but they pay the business for its goods and pay nothing to ShopBot. For this reason, ShopBot can also be described as **B2B2C** (business-to-business-to-consumer): the business pays, and the consumer uses the product. This is important, because if shoppers find the bot difficult to use, the business receives fewer orders and may cancel its subscription.

The B2B model also fits ShopBot's sales approach. B2B customers make rational decisions based on cost and return, so ShopBot competes by being much cheaper and faster to launch than a custom website or mobile app. B2B relationships are usually long-term, which gives ShopBot stable, recurring monthly revenue. Finally, ShopBot reaches its clients through B2B channels such as business associations (Atameken), LinkedIn and Telegram business communities.

The other three categories do not match ShopBot's idea. A business-to-consumer (B2C) model would mean that ShopBot sells directly to shoppers, but shoppers buy from the client businesses, and ShopBot only provides the technology behind the sale. A consumer-to-business (C2B) model would mean that individuals create value and sell it to companies, as freelancers or bloggers do, and this does not happen in ShopBot. A consumer-to-consumer (C2C) model, like OLX or Krisha.kz, would mean that private people sell to each other. Although shoppers can search products from many shops on ShopBot, all sellers are registered businesses that pay for the service, not private individuals. Table 1 summarizes this comparison.

Table 1 *Comparison of Business Model Categories for ShopBot*

Category	Fits ShopBot?	Reason
B2C	No	ShopBot does not sell goods to shoppers directly
B2B	**Yes**	Businesses pay a monthly subscription for the platform
C2B	No	Individuals do not sell anything to ShopBot
C2C	No	All sellers on ShopBot are registered businesses, not private people

3. ShopBot Business Model Overview

Figure 1 shows the complete Business Model Canvas of ShopBot. Its nine blocks answer the four main questions of a business model.

What does ShopBot sell? ShopBot sells a no-code Telegram shop bot with a product catalog, cart, checkout through Kaspi Pay and Halyk Bank, order notifications, a manager dashboard and basic sales analytics. It also offers shoppers a shared product search: a shopper can look for one item, filter it by price, size or material, and see offers from many partner shops at once.

How will ShopBot market its product? ShopBot will reach business owners through LinkedIn, Instagram, targeted advertising, Telegram business communities and referrals from Atameken and other business associations. The shared product search also works as a marketing channel, because shoppers discover partner shops through ShopBot.

What expenses will ShopBot face? The largest expense is salaries for developers, sales and support staff. Other costs are cloud hosting, marketing, payment and API fees, office rent and legal costs. Most of these costs are fixed: the platform costs about the same to run for ten clients or for one thousand.

How will ShopBot make a profit? ShopBot earns recurring monthly revenue from subscriptions. Micro-businesses pay for the Starter plan, SMEs pay for the Business plan plus a small payment-processing fee, and large brands pay the Business price plus a fee for each active monthly user. Because most costs are fixed, every new subscriber adds profit once ShopBot passes its break-even point.

Figure 1 *Business Model Canvas of ShopBot*

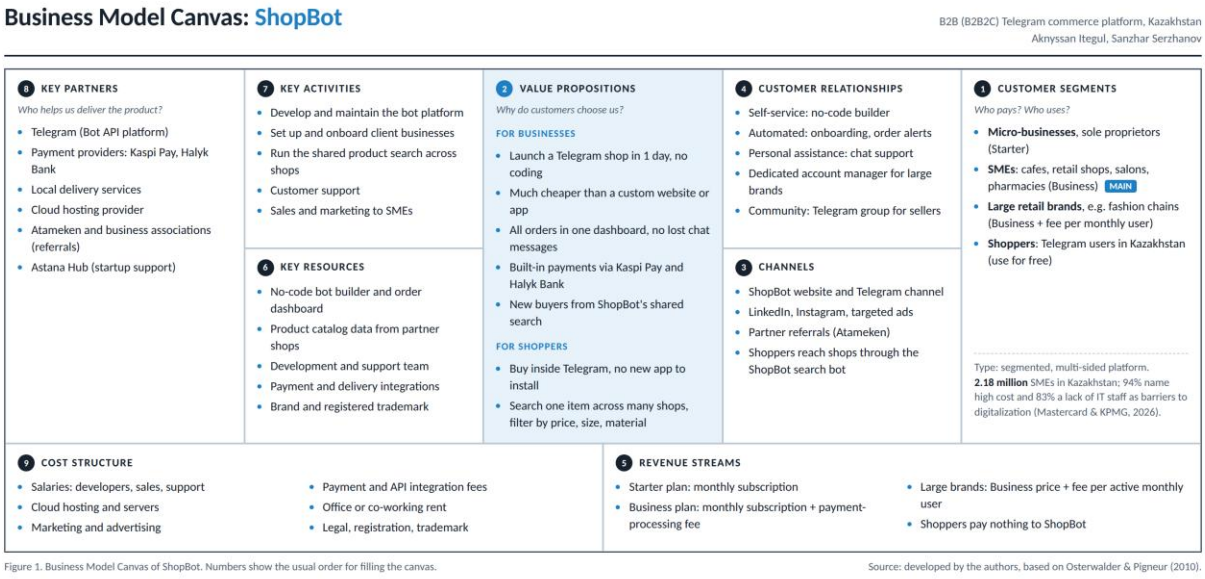


Figure 1. Business Model Canvas of ShopBot. Numbers show the usual order for filling the canvas.

Source: developed by the authors, based on Osterwalder & Pigneur (2010).

ShopBot combines two business model patterns described by Osterwalder and Pigneur (2010). First, it is a **multi-sided platform**. Just as the Apple App Store connects iPhone users with app developers, ShopBot connects shoppers with businesses, and each side becomes more valuable as the other side grows. Second, it uses the **FREE pattern**, in which a non-paying customer segment is financed by another segment: shoppers use ShopBot for free, while businesses pay for subscriptions. In terms of business model innovation, ShopBot is **customer-driven**, because it is built around the need of SME owners for easy and low-cost access to online sales.

4. Step 2. Building the Value Proposition

4.1 Customer Segments

ShopBot serves two sides. Businesses pay for the service, and shoppers use it for free. Because ShopBot offers different plans to different types of businesses, its segmentation is **segmented**, and because both sides need each other, it is also a **multi-sided platform**. Table 2 describes the four segments.

- **Micro-businesses** are sole proprietors and very small sellers, such as home bakers and Instagram shops. They need a cheap and simple way to sell online. This is a large group: individual entrepreneurs make up 69% of all SMEs in Kazakhstan (Mastercard & KPMG, 2026).
- **Small and medium businesses (main segment)** are cafes, restaurants, retail shops, beauty salons and pharmacies. Kazakhstan has about 2.18 million SMEs, which produce 40% of the country's GDP and employ half of its working population (Mastercard & KPMG, 2026). These businesses already receive many orders through messengers, so they feel the problem

of lost and slow orders the most, and they can afford a monthly fee. For this reason, the Value Proposition Canvas in Section 4.2 is built for this segment.

- **Large retail brands**, for example fashion chains such as Zara or Pull&Bear, need a fast ordering channel, connection to their own systems and personal support.
- **Shoppers** are Telegram users in Kazakhstan. Telegram is the second most popular messenger in the country, with about 7.6 million users (Similarweb, 2025). Shoppers want to buy quickly without installing a new app and to compare one product in many shops. They do not pay ShopBot, but without them businesses would have no reason to pay.

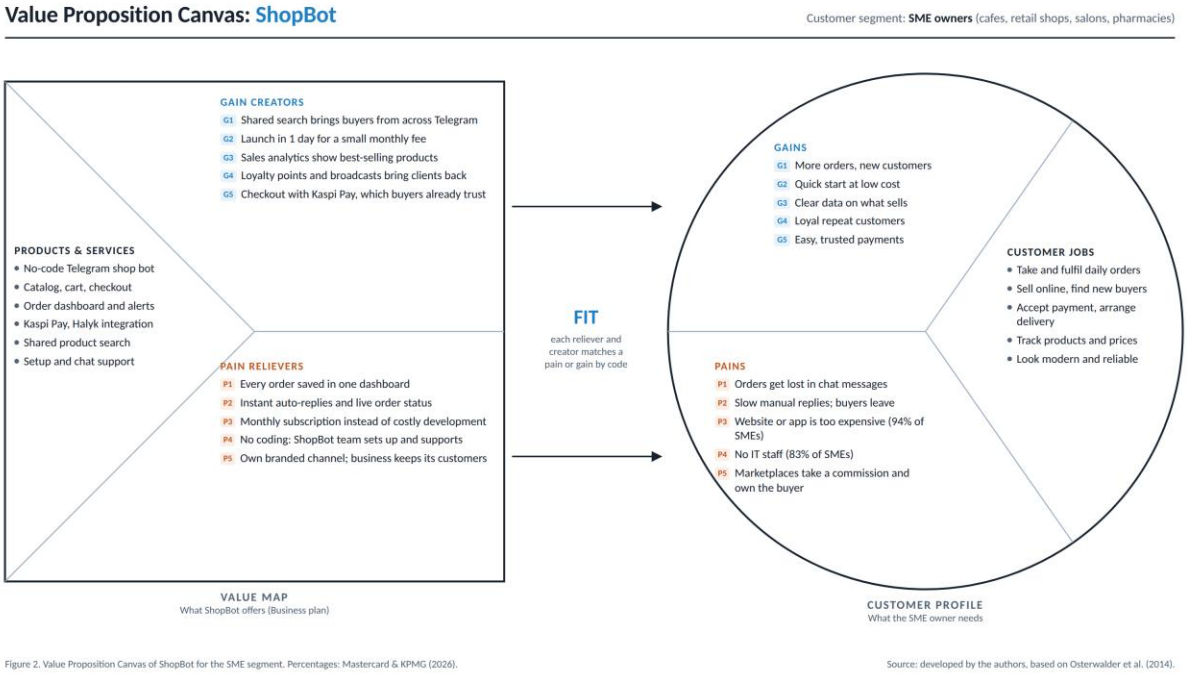
Table 2 *ShopBot Customer Segments*

Segment	Who	Main need	Plan / price
Micro-businesses	Sole proprietors, home sellers	Sell online cheaply, no coding	Starter
SMEs (main)	Cafes, shops, salons, pharmacies	Organize orders, payments and reports	Business
Large brands	Shop chains, fashion brands	Fast channel, custom setup	Business + fee per user
Shoppers	Telegram users in Kazakhstan	Easy buying, comparing shops	Free

4.2 Value Proposition Canvas

The Value Proposition Canvas (Figure 2) was built for the main segment, SME owners. The right side (the circle) describes the customer, and the left side (the square) describes what ShopBot offers. Following the method of Osterwalder et al. (2014), the customer profile was completed first. Each pain (P1–P5) and each gain (G1–G5) has a matching pain reliever or gain creator with the same code, which shows the fit between the product and the customer.

Figure 2 *Value Proposition Canvas of ShopBot for the SME Segment*



Customer jobs. An SME owner needs to take and complete daily orders, sell online and find new buyers, accept payments and arrange delivery, and keep track of products and prices. The owner also has a social job: to look modern and reliable in front of customers.

Pains and pain relievers. Many shops take orders in chats, where messages get lost (P1) and managers reply slowly, so buyers leave (P2). ShopBot saves every order in one dashboard and answers shoppers instantly with order status updates. A website or app is too expensive for most SMEs (P3), and most have no IT staff (P4): 94% of SMEs name high implementation cost and 83% name a shortage of IT specialists as barriers to digitalization (Mastercard & KPMG, 2026). ShopBot replaces a large development cost with a small monthly fee and requires no coding. Finally, marketplaces take a commission and own the relationship with the buyer (P5), while a ShopBot bot carries the shop's own brand, so the shop keeps its customers.

Gains and gain creators. SME owners want more orders (G1), a fast and cheap start (G2), clear data on what sells (G3), loyal customers (G4) and trusted payment methods (G5). ShopBot creates these gains through its shared product search, launch within one day, simple sales analytics, loyalty points and broadcast messages, and checkout with Kaspi Pay, which Kazakhstani shoppers already know and trust.

Fit. Every pain and gain in the customer profile has a matching answer in the value map, and the two biggest pains, cost and lack of IT staff, are confirmed by real data. This shows that ShopBot addresses real problems of its customers rather than invented ones.

4.3 Value Proposition Statement

ShopBot helps small and medium businesses in Kazakhstan turn their Telegram chats into a real online shop in one day, without a website, without coding and for a small monthly fee.

Today, many cafes, shops and salons take orders through WhatsApp and Telegram messages. Orders get lost, managers answer slowly, and customers leave. At the same time, a custom website or mobile app is too expensive for most of these businesses, and very few of them have their own IT specialists (Mastercard & KPMG, 2026).

ShopBot solves these problems with a ready-made Telegram shop bot. Customers browse a catalog, add items to a cart, pay with Kaspi Pay or Halyk Bank and follow the status of their order, all inside the messenger they already use every day. The business owner sees every order in one dashboard, receives simple sales reports and can bring customers back with loyalty points and promotional messages.

What makes ShopBot different from other bot builders is its shared product search. Shoppers can search for one item, for example a hoodie, filter it by price, size or material and see offers from many partner shops. This means that ShopBot does not only give a business a sales tool; it also brings new buyers to it. Unlike marketplaces, ShopBot does not take the customer away from the shop: every bot carries the shop's own brand, and the shop keeps its customer list.

In short, ShopBot gives SMEs the benefits of e-commerce at the cost and effort of a messenger chat.

4.4 Customer Relationships

Customer relationships describe how ShopBot communicates with its customers in order to get new customers, keep existing ones and help them grow. For a subscription business, keeping customers is the most important goal, because a shop that pays every month for several years brings much more revenue than a shop that leaves after one month. ShopBot will use five types of relationships:

- **Self-service:** owners build and manage their bot alone with the no-code builder, supported by video guides and step-by-step instructions.
- **Automated services:** the system sends welcome messages, setup tips, new-order alerts and weekly sales reports, and shoppers receive automatic replies and order updates.
- **Personal assistance:** owners can contact the ShopBot support team in Telegram chat and get help from a real person.
- **Dedicated personal assistance:** large brands receive their own account manager who helps with setup and integration.
- **Community:** a Telegram group for sellers where owners share ideas, ask questions and learn about new features.

Table 3 *Customer Relationships by Customer Segment*

Segment	Main relationship types	Reason
Micro-businesses	Self-service, automated services, community	Low price, so support must be low-cost
SMEs (main)	Self-service, automated services, personal assistance, community	They need help sometimes, but not every day
Large brands	Dedicated account manager, personal assistance	They pay the most and need a custom setup
Shoppers	Automated services	They use ShopBot for free, so service is automatic

These relationships work at every stage. To **get** customers, ShopBot offers a free trial period, video guides and referrals from Atameken. To **keep** them, it provides fast chat support, a seller community and weekly reports that show the value ShopBot brings. To **grow**, it suggests that shops move from the Starter plan to the Business plan when their number of orders increases.

5. Conclusion

ShopBot is a B2B platform with a B2B2C character: businesses pay for it, and shoppers use it. Its business model combines the multi-sided platform and FREE patterns, and it earns stable income from monthly subscriptions. The Value Proposition Canvas shows a clear fit between the problems of Kazakhstani SMEs and ShopBot's solutions, especially the high cost of going online and the lack of IT staff. The shared product search is ShopBot's main competitive advantage, because it not only helps businesses sell but also brings them new customers. The next step for the team is to test this value proposition with real SME owners through interviews and a simple prototype.

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AI Contribution Map

Section	Own work	AI-assisted	AI-generated	Brief explanation
Business idea (ShopBot)	✓			Idea, target market and subscription plans created by the team in Assignment 1
Step 1. Business model category	✓			The choice of B2B was made and checked by the team
Business model overview		✓		Created based on our Assignment 1
Business Model Canvas (Figure 1)		✓		Team provided the content (segments, pricing for large brands, shared search idea); AI designed the canvas
Customer Segments	✓			Segment decisions based on BM; statistics checked against the original source
Value Proposition Canvas (Figure 2)		✓		Created by AI from information provided by team; the team reviewed all pains, gains and solutions
Introduction, Value Proposition Statement, Conclusion		✓		Drafted by AI; reviewed and edited by the team
Customer Relationships	✓			Made by team, researched, verified
Sources		✓		AI helped with APA formatting; the team checked every source